

« The instant wherein that supreme quality of beauty, the clear radiance of the esthetic image, is apprehended luminously by the mind which has been arrested by its wholeness and fascinated by its harmony is the luminous silent stasis of esthetic pleasure, a spiritual state called the enchantment of the heart. »

— J. Joyce, *A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man*, 1916

The essence of Cartier reveals itself through the related concepts of beauty, love and fertility. The former two are necessary conditions for the last since beauty and love combine to form the basis of creation.

Central to life, albeit sometimes hidden from the vulgar eye, such beauties are the object of the fierce and constant quest that forms the leitmotif of the Maison Cartier, infusing its very raison d'être since the beginning, in the beating heart of the nineteenth century, and conferring on each piece a timeless radiance which awakens in us the certain feeling of the very first time.

Cartier breathes the manifestation of beauty in its celestial and perfect form and at the same time gives rise to the birth of its own sublime and transcendent essence, admirable and admired by all.





« Aphrodite arrived on Ida of the many springs, mother of wild beasts and she went straight across the mountain for the farmstead. Along with her came fawning wolves of gray and harsh-eyed lions and bears and swift panthers ever hungry for deer. When she saw them she was delighted in her heart and injected desire in their chests; two by two they all went to lie down throughout the shady haunts. »

— Homeric Hymn to Aphrodite

The beauty of Cartier is made flesh in the Goddess Aphrodite. Her seductive beauty has power over men, gods and the wild beasts – swift-footed panthers – which sometimes accompany her, symbolising the irresistible power of fertility. Daughter of the aphros, the primordial sea-foam, from the moment of her tempestuous birth she has incarnated and subsumed into herself the fierce love and sensual pleasure so integral to our lives as humans.



« It is necessary to have chaos on the inside in order to give birth to a dancing star. »

— F. Nietzsche, Thus Spoke Zarathustra, 1983

It is a beauty that exists in a state of exquisite tension between Apollonian order and Dionysian excess; between a physical appearance based on order, rationality and serenity and – its complete opposite – a celebration of the senses, of wild instinct and ecstatic rapture.

Apollo is the here, the academic representation of the Cartier body and the clear light that emanates from it. Dionysus is the elsewhere, alien and yet deeply familiar at the same time. The Cartier Odyssey, its works inspired by far-flung voyages in distant lands and different times.

« "Do you think that a man's life is commonplace when he has his eyes on the sky, contemplates this beauty by the right means, and lives in union with it? Do you not think," she says, "that only then, when he sees beauty through the organ that makes it visible, will he be able to give birth not to simulacra of virtue, for he does not cling to a simulacrum, but to true virtue, for he clings to the truth? Now, if he gives birth to true virtue and nurtures it, does it not belong to him to be loved by the gods and, of all men, to become immortal?" »

— Plato, *Symposium* (Diotima of Mantinea), 380 BCE

The refined and the intense, the pure and the ardent, the reserved and the sparkling, discreet elegance and joyous excess - these opposites mingle, balance one another and create a tension that releases a surging creative force, guided always by the common thread of style.

Love is the link of flesh and spirit binding Cartier to its art and uniting us with their jewelled creations. The law of union and cohesion to which all creatures may succumb and yet, at the same time, an upward path in its celebration of the beautiful.

« Love has no age; it is always being born. The poets have told us this, which is why love is always shown as a child. We ask nothing of it yet we feel it. »

— B. Pascal, *Discourse on the passions of love*, 1652

The child of Aphrodite in Greek mythology, conceived and nourished in beauty, it reminds us of the universal, sovereign and eternal youth that all deep loves confer.





« The inspiring properties of May and the fever of love have the same origin (...) That is why the exhilaration of spring pours such a powerful disturbance into our hearts, awakens such a deep echo in our souls, triggers in us such a joyful excitement. »

— Vladimir Jankélévitch, *Treaty of Virtues*, 1993

For Cartier love and beauty are linked in never-ending intimate exchange; the love of beauty and beauty revealed through love. This makes the jeweller's art fertile with pieces before which our being blossoms, spreads and, in its turn, creates.

This eternal cycle of rebirth – the new flowering of each Spring – “sings the orgies of universal renewal” and incubates in its extraordinary and maternal body, “the generosity of Nature; inexhaustible, never-failing Nature.”

So it is that great love, beauty and fertility join together and form themselves into an eternally self-renewing ballet. It is physical, intellectual and creative and it forms the body, heart and soul of the Maison Cartier. ■

Homeric Hymn to Aphrodite 3: 5.68-99

Ἴδην δ' ἴκανεν πολυπίδακα, μητέρα θηρῶν,
βῆ δ' ἰθὺς σταθμοῖο δι' οὖρεος· οἱ δὲ μετ' αὐτὴν
σαίνοντες πολλοὶ τε λύκοι χαροποὶ τε λέοντες
ἄρκτοι παρδάλιές τε θοαὶ προκαδὼν ἀκόρητοι
ἦσαν· ἡ δ' ὀρώωσα μετὰ φρεσὶ τέρπετο θυμὸν
καὶ τοῖς ἐν στήθεσσι βάλ' ἱμερον, οἱ δ' ἅμα πάντες
σύνδυο κοιμήσαντο κατὰ σκιόεντας ἐναύλους.
αὐτὴ δ' ἐς κλισίας εὐποιήτους ἀφίκανε·
τὸν δ' εὖρε σταθμοῖσι λελειμμένον οἶον ἀπ' ἄλλων
Ἀγχίστην ἦρωα θεῶν ἄπο κάλλος ἔχοντα.
οἱ δ' ἅμα βουσίην ἔποντο νομοὺς κάτα ποιήεντας
πάντες, ὃ δὲ σταθμοῖσι λελειμμένος οἶος ἀπ' ἄλλων
πωλεῖτ' ἐνθα καὶ ἐνθα διαπρύσιον καθαρίζων.
στῆ δ' αὐτοῦ προπάρειθε Διὸς θυγάτηρ Ἀφροδίτη
παρθένω ἀδμήτῃ μέγεθος καὶ εἶδος ὁμοίῃ,
μὴ μιν ταρβήσειεν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖσι νοήσας.
Ἀγχίστης δ' ὀρώων ἐφράζετο θαύμαινέν τε
εἰδὸς τε μέγεθος καὶ εἵματα σιγαλόεντα.
πέπλον μὲν γὰρ ἔεστο φαινότερον πυρὸς ἀγῆς,
εἶχε δ' ἐπιγναμπτὰς ἔλικας κάλυκας τε φαινίνας,
ὄρμοι δ' ἄμφ' ἀπαλῇ δειρῇ περικαλλέες ἦσαν
καλοὶ χρύσειοι παμποίκιλοι· ὥς δὲ σελήνῃ
στήθεσιν ἄμφ' ἀπαλοῖσιν ἐλάμπετο, θαῦμα ιδέσθαι.
Ἀγχίστην δ' ἔρος εἶλεν, ἔπος δέ μιν ἀντίον ἠῶδα·
Χαῖρε ἄνασσ', ἥ τις μακάρων τάδε δώμαθ' ἰκάνεις,
Ἄρτεμις ἡ Λητώ ἢ χρυσέῃ Ἀφροδίτῃ
ἢ Θέμις ἡ ὕγενὴς ἢ γλαυκῶπις Ἀθήνῃ
ἢ πού τις Χαρίτων δεῦρ' ἤλυθες, αἶ τε θεοῖσι
πᾶσιν ἑταιρίζουσι καὶ ἀθάνατοι καλέονται,
ἢ τῆς νυμφάων αἶ τ' ἄλσεα καλὰ νέμονται,
ἢ νυμφῶν αἶ καλὸν ὄρος τόδε ναιετάουσι
καὶ πηγὰς ποταμῶν καὶ πῖσα ποιήεντα.

She arrived on Ida of the many springs, mother of wild beasts
and she went straight across the mountain for the farmstead.
Along with her came fawning wolves of gray and harsh-eyed lions
and bears and swift panthers ever hungry for roes. When she saw
them she was delighted in her heart and injected desire in their chests;
two by two they all went off to lie down throughout the
the shady haunts. She herself arrived at the well-built hut.
Him she found by the byre, left all alone apart from the others,
Him, Anchises the hero whose beauty comes from the gods.
The others were following their cattle among the grassy pastures,
all of them, but he, left all alone apart from the others by the byre,
was walking back and forth playing loudly on his lyre.
Aphrodite the daughter of Zeus stood before him
like an unbedded virgin in stature and shapeliness so she
would not frighten him when he looked and noticed her.
Anchises saw her and thought about it, astonished at
her shapeliness and stature and glossy clothing.
For she was dressed in a shift shinier than a ray of fire,
and she wore spiral bracelets and brilliant earrings
and around her soft throat were exquisite necklaces —
beautiful, golden, ornate: like the moon they shone
about her soft breasts, a wonder to look at.
Passion took hold of Anchises, and he spoke a word to her face:
“Greetings, mistress, you who come as one of the blessed gods
to this home – Artemis or Leto or golden Aphrodite or
well-born Themis or grey-eyed Athena, or perhaps you’re one of
the Graces come here – they are companions with all the gods
and are called immortals – or one of the nymphs who dwell in
beautiful groves or one of the nymphs who inhabit this
beautiful mountain or the springs for rivers and the grassy meadows.



« The nature by which a thing opens itself, is a production, is creation. Nature is even creation in the highest sense. For what is present has in itself that possibility of opening up which is implied in production, for example the possibility that the flower has of opening up in the flowering. »

— M. Heidegger, *The Question Concerning Technology*, 1958

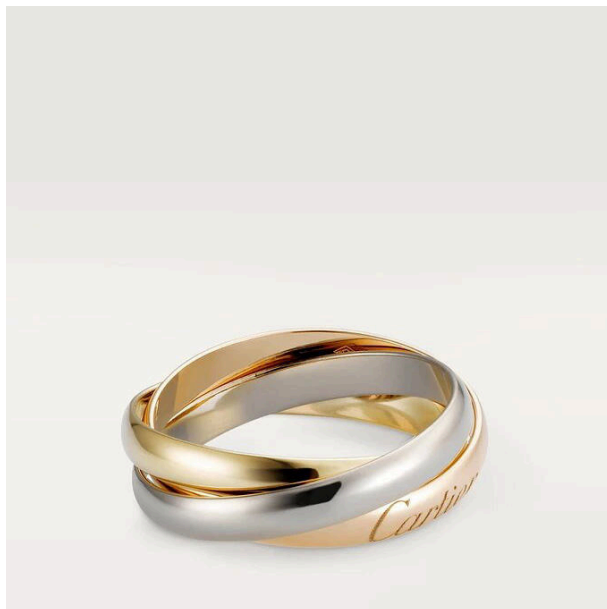
« We - the craftsmen - take a turn around the material for a moment, then let go. Our anxieties vanish, the gesture becomes more serene, experienced, ardent and precise. We choose the raw material with the heart, work with love... We wage an incessant battle against time in order to finish as soon as possible. Patience is the only way to achieve this. The density of the stone, its veins must be tamed and the difficulty associated with it overcome. It is the stone - and only the stone - that guides the hand. As a jeweller, Cartier understands this. »

— P. Nicolas, Master of Art Glyptician at Cartier

Cartier excavates all beauties from their high and hidden places and works upon them to reveal their intrinsic grace, the reality of their nature and demonstrate to the onlooker their immanent beauty, finely worked towards perfection.

The raw material squeezed from the earth enters a sculptural dialogue between the artisan and the piece as it becomes the goldsmith's work. The fusion of art and matter occurs when the cunning hand hears the initiating word that arises from this exchange. Creation escaping the lapidary hand, taking on its own life and blazing into truth.





« First he made a large and compact shield. On it he fashioned the earth, on it the sky, on it the sea, the sun without fatigue and the moon in fullness, and on it all the wonders with which the sky is crowned, the Pleiades and the Hyades and the strength of Orion and the Bear, which is also called the Chariot, which turns on the spot and spies on Orion, the only one without a bath in the ocean. »

— Homer, *The Iliad*, Book XVIII

The magic which operates at the creation of these works fuses the Maison Cartier with the mythic figure of Hephaestus¹, the alchemist god, turning metal into glorious creations in the shadows of his volcanic forge and the light of his inspiration.

He is husband to Aphrodite and dedicated artist, celestial yet of the earth, a modest presence in the world but elevated in his art to the sparkling summit of Olympus. He heads the pantheon of artisans and smiths in precious metals at Cartier, those who breathe the vital essence into the works of their hands: “Subtle magicians, shards of the moon on a string of pure sun.”

The act of transformation merges with the revelatory and hidden magic of these arts. The fragments of the moon in close communion with the stone and the sun’s glory on the connecting thread provided by the consummate achievement of these masters of their art.

¹ « First of all, there is the myth of the artist par excellence, the divine craftsman who knows how to create marvels and whose story recalls so many features of Homer’s: Hephaestus, the lame man, the deceived one (by his wife, Aphrodite in the Odyssey), who makes the gods laugh when he goes off to serve them wine with his ill-righted gait, he who has done so much for them, who has built them splendid houses in Olympus. He is the typical artist, the model of Homer: an ungainly being who produces grace. » — Pierre Judet de la Combe, Homer.

These craftsmen, artists, of the House
 - *homo faber* of the gifted hands -
 capture and reflect the living beauty
 of the universe in their works through
 their unique mastery of alchemical
 knowledge and techniques.

«Jewels, which seem to gather the value and importance of their radiance on a small point, make the personality's assets a visible quality of its being. They create a wider circle around the circle of simple necessity, which is in essence unlimited.»

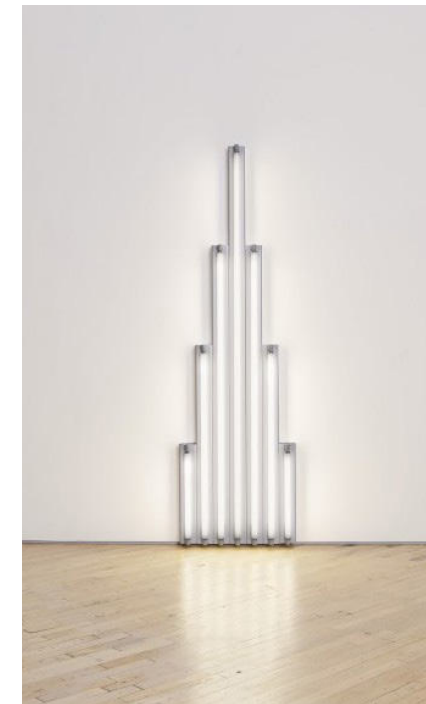
— G. Simmel, *The Adornment & Other Essays*, 1998

Born from sculpted and subtly fused materials, the stones and their settings act as much to seduce as to protect; exalting the power of all who wear them and enabling them to face the world in the true affirmation of their vulnerability.

« Adornment is simply selfishness, insofar as it makes the wearer stand out. It carries and increases his self-love to the detriment of others (for the same ornament for all would not adorn the individual). At the same time, it is altruism, which precisely gives others the pleasure it gives - while the possessor himself can only enjoy it in the moment when he looks in the mirror - and it is first of all the gift that gives the ornament its value. »

— G. Simmel, *The Adornment & Other Essays*, 1998

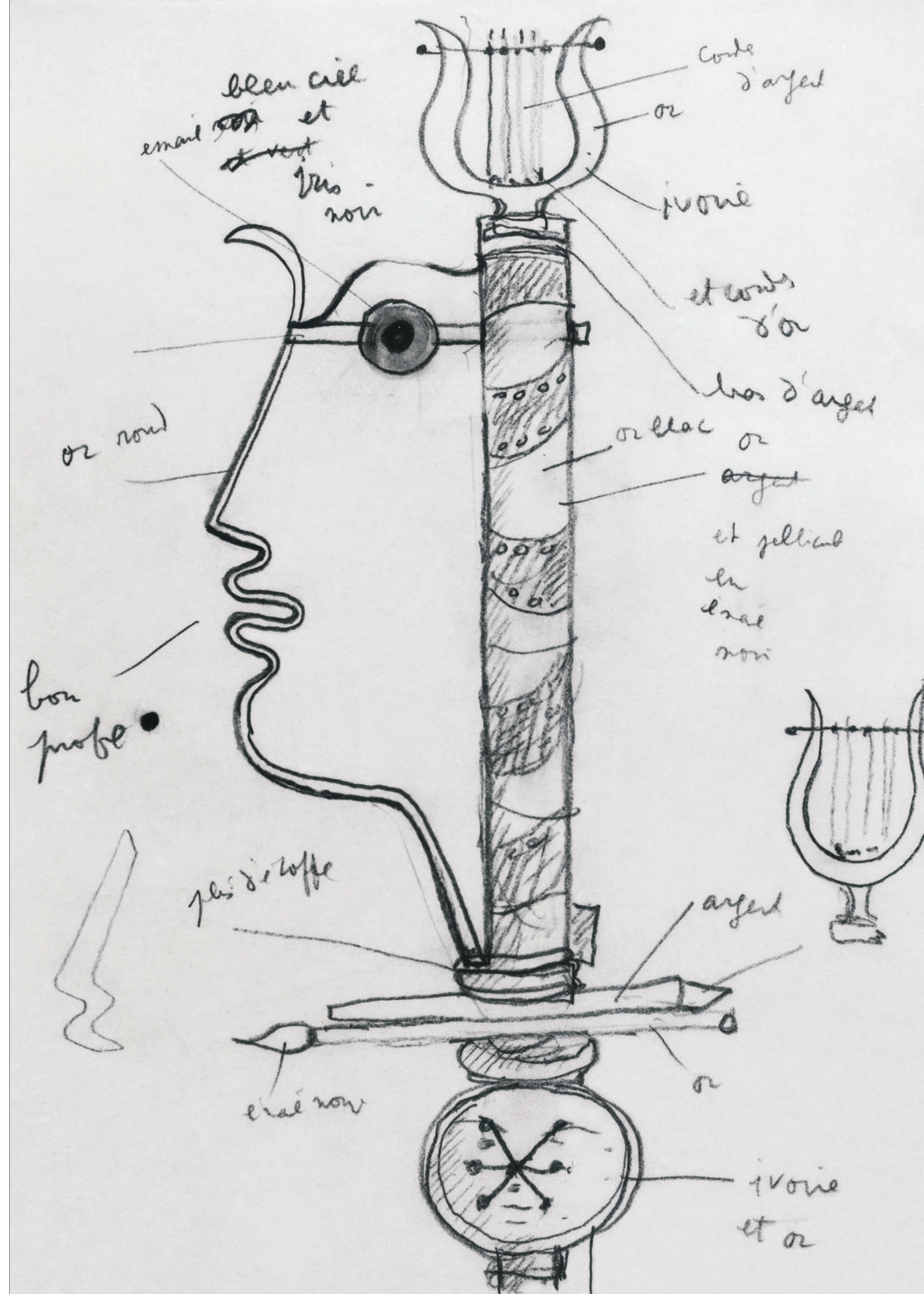
Apart from their quality as a sparkling shield - “multiple beauty, born of the cunningly wise” - the masterpieces created by Cartier nourish the aura of the wearer and surpass their dualities, ravishing the senses of all who come within their orbit. The work, in its generosity, is as much for the wearer as for the other. Through synchronous art, and at one and the same time, egotist and altruist. ■



JEAN COCTEAU, THE FRIVOLOUS PRINCE, 1910

Sunshine! I'm eighteen and the empire is mine!
 Buttonhole twinkling like rare rosé wine
 Finer than starlight of quadruple beryl
 Adorable danger and spellbinding peril,
 The car flings itself round the Champs Elysées
 The sprinklers directing their rockets my way,
 Monsieur de Frizoli clings to the couch:
 The runaway chestnut trees, seeing him slouch,
 In order to chase of his gloom and his shame
 Have set out green candles with flickering pink flame.
 I drink in the air and recover my strength
 From the thunderous road jammed for all of its length
 With slow-rolling traffic between walls of glass.
 Where Napoleon sternly brings judgement to pass
 On the contest of colour and perfume and sound!
 Be joyful, my friend, as the cup is passed round,
 All ve senses will dance to the band in our heads:
 Here's Guerlain unfurling his flowery beds
Cartier, the subtle magician, who threads
shards of the moon on a string of pure sun,
 And Charvet, who gives the rainbow inspiration
 And suffers the orchids' unfair imitation,
 Along with mimosas, violets and carnations,
 Gold on horseback, it's Eden, the goal, final haven,
 And how deeply this scene on my heart is engraven!

Soleil ! J'ai dix-huit ans ! Cet empire me reste !
 J'arbore un œillet rare au revers de ma veste
 Et c'est mieux que l'étoile à quadruple béryl.
 Adorable danger, étourdissant péril,
 L'auto fait des bonds mous par les Champs-Élysées !
 Les arroseurs vers moi dirigent leurs fusées,
 Monsieur de Frizoli se cramponne aux coussins:
 Les marronniers fuyards, en de sournois desseins,
 Ont mis, pour éclairer ses peureuses névroses,
 Des candélabres vert avec des flammes roses !
 Je bois à l'abreuvoir de l'air, je me repais
 De cette rue étourdissante de la Paix
 Où l'on roule léger entre deux murs de verre !
 Où Napoléon juge, immobile et sévère,
 Le tournoi des couleurs, des parfums et des sons !
 - Convive sois joyeux, voici les échansons ;
 Tes cinq sens vont danser de folles sarabandes.
 Voici Guerlain, ce détrousseur de plates-bandes,
Cartier qui fait tenir, magicien subtil,
De la lune en morceaux sur du soleil en fil,
 Et puis Charvet où l'arc-en-ciel prend des idées !
 Partout ce sont des plagiaires d'orchidées,
 De mimosas, d'œillets, de violettes. L'or
 Voltige, c'est l'Eden, c'est le but, c'est le port !
 Ah! Comme dans mon cœur ce spectacle se grave !



Through the hands of its cunning virtuosi, Cartier creates a sanctuary for beauties given sudden form. We are guided through its hallways by the feline footsteps of the panther, our loyal and magnificent escort and our protector on this journey.

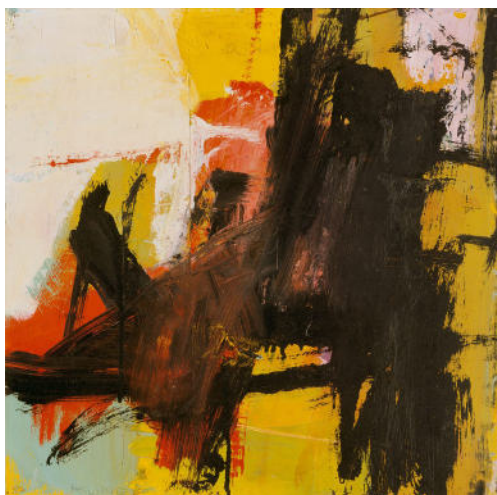
« On a famous statuette by Catal Huyuk, the Goddess, obese, is giving birth, seated on panthers which serve as her throne; in Hacilar, the same character, also seated on a panther, holds in her arms either a child or a young fawn. In this way, in surrealist assemblages that clearly belong to the world of the imagination, the ideas of fertility, maternity, royalty and control over wild animals converge. »

— J. Cauvin, *The Revolution of Symbols*, 1994

On the thrones of the Neolithic era, the original goddesses reign. At their sides, as a majestic symbol of their elementary power, their faithful panthers crouch at peace in the sleek intensity of their powerful bodies.

Potnia Theron is the name of this ancient lineage of prehistoric divinities: Mistress of wild beasts, savage lives and untamed beautiful adept of the warrior arts. The unseizable, shapeshifting through the ages: Artemis, sister of Apollo; Aphrodite, mother of beasts; Dionysus the androgyne; and then panther – alter egos in a subtle continuum.





« The attributes of the Oriental Goddess are the fawns, vultures and other animals dangerous to man, which are her immediate retinue and specify her powers. As a divinity, the universal Mother is installed on the transcendent plane where fears and conflicts are resolved, where the complicit fawn becomes a seat, where the tearing fang and the raptor's beak are another, more hidden, aspect of the nourishing breast, as if sustenance, from a certain point of view, paradoxically irrigated life. »

— J. Cauvin, *The Revolution of Symbols*, 1994

«Such a fragrant animal cannot itself remain insensitive to the scents around it. This is why, it seems, panthers are frequently caught in the region of Pamphylia, which has many aromatic species. Attracted by the fragrant effluvia, the panthers come from Armenia through the mountains, cross the Taurus and move towards the gum of the styrax tree, when the wind begins to blow and the trees start to give off their scent.»

– M. Detienne, *The Perfumed Panther*, 1998

«Fuerat & pardalium in Tarso: cujus etiam compositio & mixtura oblitterata est.»

«Long ago there existed a pardalium in the city of Tarsus but the ingredients and composition are no longer known. »

– Pliny the Elder, *Natural History*

The panther, unshackled and imperious – present in all that is female – roams in unknown or coveted lands on its black velvet paws; from dusk till dawn, but also in the full light of day.

She is the wild incarnation of the beauty and power we contemplate in nature. Her virtuosity and mastery serve as metaphor of the victory of the cosmos over chaos; a symbol of power, strength and majesty.

Her sleek and sinewy movements give off a balmy scent, unlike any other animal. It attracts and inspires across time, as described by Aristotle who wrote of his astonishment at the delicate essence hovering in the air around the beast.

Long ago, in the ancient city of Tarsus, a perfume was created – known by the name of *Pardalium*, the panther – the secret of whose composition was already lost by the time of Pliny the Elder¹.

¹ Pliny the Elder, *Natural History*, Book XIII (Species of Perfume and Twelve Compositions)

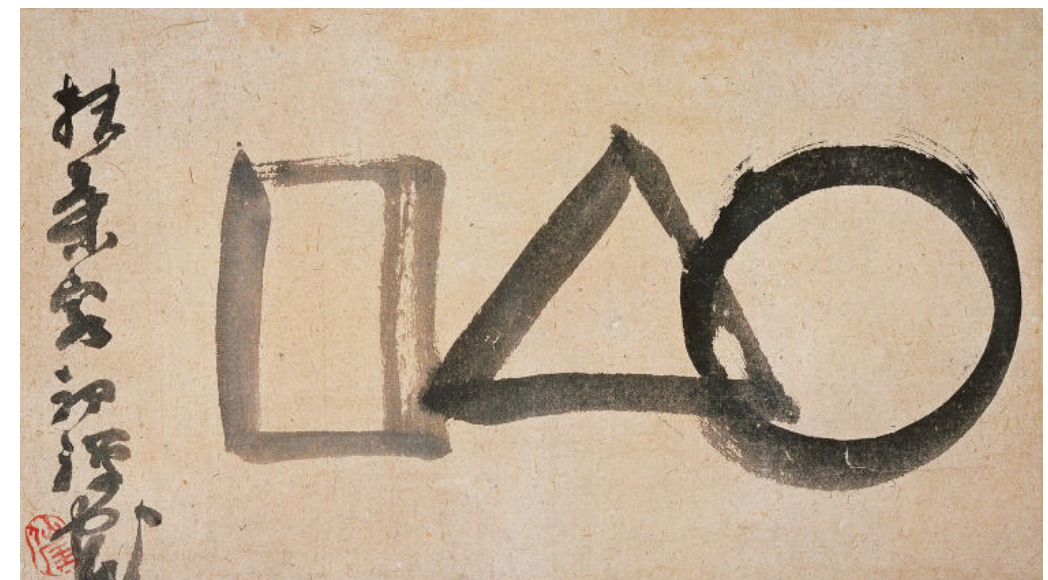
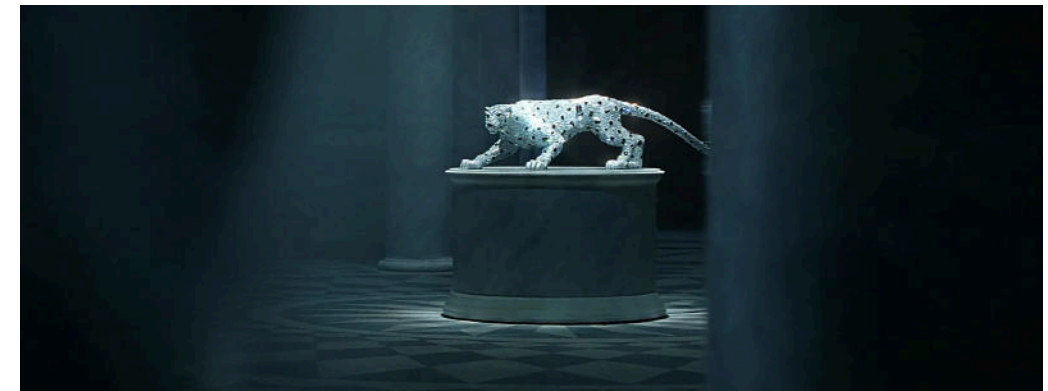
The panther goes beyond her appointed role as nature's protector of the beautiful and serves as the keystone of the vault, as Hermes, messenger and world-connecting go-between, opening the doors of the Maison Cartier to us and allowing us into the sudden presence of a universe of fertile creation.

« The daimon interprets and communicates to the gods what comes from men and to men what comes from the gods: the prayers and sacrifices of the former, the injunctions of the latter and their favours, in exchange for sacrifices; and, on the other hand, being intermediate between the one and the other, what is demonic is complementary to it, so as to put the Whole in connection with itself. Thanks to this middle nature, it is in a complete way that the gods are able to enter into relation with men and to converse with them, either during wakefulness or during sleep. »

— Plato, *Symposium* (Diotima of Mantinea), 380 BCE

It is here, in these halls, studded with the works of artists and artisans, that an endless odyssey begins: between the worlds of the imagined, the real and the legendary, the subterranean and the celestial; so many passages from the here and now to the beyond. All beneath the agate gaze of the untamed guardian panther, the palace gargoyle whose eyes are watching night and day.

Guardian and considered from the Neolithic era to our own as a protective goddess, the panther is both guard and guide, watchful and informed, accompanying each hero on the voyage and warding off evil on the way; from Santos-Dumont to the Cartier brothers and all who venture boldly in the Maison Cartier. ■



DE LA PANTERA, MORALISED BESTIARY, 13th CENTURY
ANTOLOGIA DELLA POESIA ITALIANA

Vocase una animalia panthera,
ke alenando tale odore rende,
ne lo paese no remane fera
ke non ce corra, quando se protende,

senza lo drago, ké no 'l sofererra
lo pretioso odore ke li offende:
ella se pasce per tale mainera.
Homo, a salute d'anima se 'ntende:

Cristo è la fera co lo dolze odore,
quelle ke corrono l'anime sante,
de le quali per vivo amar se pasce;

lo drago è lo Nemico traditore,
ke de Lui odorar non è possente,
e pena dolorosa le ne nasce.

A panther is an animal
which, on breathing, exhales such a smell
that there is no animal in the country
that does not run to it when it rises

except the dragon, who could not suffer
the precious odour that assails him:
so she feeds.
We are speaking here of the salvation of the soul.

Christ is the sweet-smelling beast,
the beasts that run after holy souls,
of whom he feasts with a lively love;

the dragon is the treacherous enemy,
who cannot feel Him,
without a painful grief coming upon him.

